Misconfiguration

Specific configurations of operating systems and networks such as allowing users to execute commands on the server can be dangerous. As mentioned earlier, if the user does not have good password hackers can run malicious scripts on the server.

Bugs in the operating system and web servers

Bugs discovered in the operating system or web server's software can be used to gain access to the system without authorization.

Lack of security policy and procedures

Lack of basic security policy and procedures such as regularly updating the antivirus software or patching the operating system and web server software can create major security loopholes for hackers to exploit.

Types of Web Servers

Before we get into the warzone, we need to know the enemy. Common web servers are listed below:

- **Apache** – The most commonly used web server on the internet (it is an open source software). 67% of all web servers employ Apache HTTP Server. Most PHP websites run on this type of web server.
- **Internet Information Services (IIS)** – It is a high-performance web server from Microsoft. It comes with Windows and is second to only Apache in usage. Most asp and aspx websites are hosted on IIS servers.
- **Nginx** – Another free open source web server. In recent times, it is getting very popular, with about 7.5% of all domains worldwide using it.
- **Other web servers** – These include Novell's Web Server, IBM's Lotus Domino servers and LightSpeed web server.

Web server attack tools

Some common web server attack tools are:

- **Metasploit** – this is an open source tool for developing, testing and using exploit code. It runs on both Unix based OS and Windows. It is used by hackers for exposing the vulnerabilities of a target.
- **MPack** – this is an exploitation tool. Written in PHP and with MySQL as the backend database engine, MPack is another popular choice of hackers. Using Mpack, we can redirect all traffic to a web server to our web server.
- **Zeus** – this is an essential tool which is used to turn a compromised